Use-Case Flow Specification

Community Lost & Found Matching Network

Use Case ID	UC-05
Use Case Name	Claim Item / Verify Ownership
Primary Actor	Owner (claimant)
Secondary Actors	Finder (sets security questions), Community Admin (manual review on repeated failure)

Preconditions

- A candidate match exists between an active Lost Item report and a Found Item report (UC-03: Match Lost & Found Items has run successfully).
- The Owner has received a match notification (UC-04) and has opted to pursue the claim.
- The Finder has set at least one private security question at the time the Found Item was posted.
- The Owner is authenticated and logged into the platform.

Postconditions

Success

- The claimant's identity is verified against the Finder's security question(s).
- The Finder's contact details are released to the Owner, and the Finder is notified that a verified claim was made.
- The item status is updated to "Claimed – Pending Handover."

Failure

- The claim is not verified; no contact details are exchanged.
- The item remains in its previous matched state, or is escalated to Community Admin for manual review.

Main Success Scenario

1. The Owner selects "Claim Item" on a Found Item post that has been matched to their Lost Item report.

2. The system displays the private security question(s) set by the Finder.

3. The Owner submits an answer to each security question.

4. The system validates the submitted answers against the Finder's stored responses.

5. The system marks the claim as verified.

6. The system releases the Finder's contact details to the Owner and notifies the Finder that a verified claim has been made.

7. The system updates the item status to "Claimed – Pending Handover."

8. The use case ends successfully.

Alternate Flow — 4a: Incorrect Answer

4a1. The system displays a "Verification failed" message and increments a failed-attempt counter for this claim.

4a2. The Owner is prompted to retry, up to a maximum of 3 attempts.

4a3. If the Owner fails all 3 attempts, the system flags the claim as suspicious and forwards it to a Community Admin for manual review (extends UC-06: Flag Suspicious Claim).

4a4. The Owner is notified that their claim has been escalated for manual review, and the use case ends in a pending state.